

mindset. When research scholars get upset over small failures, it becomes a challenge. That's where the management team comes into the picture to encourage them to shed their fear of failure. We also faced certain challenges concerning resources. To motivate our team, we made them aware of the impact of their work. When they were clear about the purpose, things fell into place.

With the current condition of Indian roads and shortage of power, or rather inadequate distribution of power in India, what're the opportunities that stand out?

We have excess power in India which is not distributed properly. Power generated in the grid needs to be stored somewhere, otherwise, it would go waste. Batteries are the only way to store that energy. If you can generate clean energy through solar and store it in a place where you can replace traditional vehicles, that's a great thing. India is not short on power. It has to be distributed properly and saved properly.

Many EV sellers are targeting end-mile delivery companies. Why is that so?

End-mile delivery is a very attractive market because the operational cost is less than of traditional IC engine vehicles. A delivery worker may be covering 80 kilometres, on average, every day, and the fuel charges for the same could be anywhere between ₹250 and ₹400. But in electric vehicles, you may spend only ₹10 to ₹20 for two units of power. This is the math that helps companies adopt electric vehicles faster. It is not the electric vehicle companies trying to sell EVs but the last-mile delivery companies who find EVs useful in their operations, because of the low operational cost. That is why there is increasing adoption of EVs by end-mile delivery companies.

What are the future trends and technologies that you see in this space, especially when it comes to battery charging and chargers?

The time taken to charge would reduce drastically in the future. Presently, it takes an average of four hours. A few companies claim that it can be done in one or two hours but that requires a special charger as well as a special cooling mechanism, which will come in the future. Secondly, you will have a common pool of batteries where you can just go to the charging station, take the charged battery, and give back the discharged battery. This is especially beneficial for last-mile delivery. For personal mobility, people usually charge their vehicles at home. Charging stations for the last mile delivery will become very prominent.

Can you tell us about the challenges you faced ever since you entered this business?

I would like to highlight two things. One is the availability of talent. When I did my master's degree in power electronics, I realised that very few people remain in this field. So, there is a lack of experienced people who are passionate about building something in power electronics. The second challenge that we faced was with respect to marketing. We assumed that since our engineering design and product are good, we could relax on the marketing front, but that was not correct. We learnt marketing and sales. It was the biggest learning struggle we had to go through for a long time. If I had to establish a startup again, I would focus more on marketing, sales, branding, as well as engineering, and not the other way round. If a startup wants to be recognised, that is the way forward. Building a brand has been the toughest thing. **EFY**

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-Jeff Bezos

